

CampusLink (HostelHub)

System Architecture, Domain Specification & Technical Blueprints

Target Institution: University of Mines and Technology (UMaT), Tarkwa
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1. Executive Summary & Core Platform Domain

CampusLink (also operating as **HostelHub**) is an enterprise-grade campus micro-economy, hostel booking, specialized academic equipment rental, peer services, and mobile wallet ecosystem specifically engineered for students, staff, and hostel managers at the **University of Mines and Technology (UMaT), Tarkwa**.

The platform addresses four critical campus operational bottlenecks:

- Hostel & Accommodation Sourcing:** Eliminates manual hostel hunting by digitizing off-campus hostel listings (e.g., Chamber of Mines Hostel, Main Gate Villa, Brahabebome Hostels) with verified room rates, distance metrics, and booking requests.
- High-Value Academic Equipment Rentals:** Solves student equipment scarcity by enabling peer-to-peer daily renting of specialized surveying total stations, Leica GPS receivers, Mohs hardness kits, laptops, scientific calculators, and lab tools.
- Peer-to-Peer Student Service Marketplace:** Connects student freelancers (typing, laundry, tutoring, drafting) with student clients under structured service contracts.
- Integrated Mobile Money & Escrow Wallet:** Provides zero-friction payments via Ghana Mobile Money (MTN MoMo, Telecel Cash, Vodafone Cash) backed by a double-entry financial ledger, automated 10% platform commissions, and escrow holds.

2. System Architecture & Verification Audit

A comprehensive system audit of the active codebase confirms a robust multi-tier architecture with **127 out of 127 passing automated tests (100% success rate)** across financial integrity, security, rate limiting, and background workers.

Component Layer	Active Technology Stack	Responsibility & Status
Database Layer	SQLite (Dev) / MySQL 8.0 (Prod)	16 Relational Tables, PRAGMA foreign keys, InnoDB DDL
Core Logic Layer	Python 3.13 Controllers	59 business functions, 15 analytical SQL reports
Financial Wallet Engine	Double-Entry Ledger + MoMo Gateway	Escrow holds, 10% commission, idempotency protection
Web Server & API	Flask REST API Gateway	53 endpoints, CORS, file uploads, health probes

Web Frontend SPA	HTML5 + CSS3 + JS Engine	Glassmorphic SPA, dark/light mode toggle, instant search
Desktop GUI App	PySide6 (Qt6) Framework	Native desktop application with 12 module views
Async Task Pipeline	Celery + Redis Broker	Background webhooks, reconciliation cron, notifications
Security Infrastructure	JWT + Rate Limiter + Audit Logger	Sliding-window rate limiter, PBKDF2 hashing, JSON audit

3. Relational Database Schema & Data Models (16 Tables)

The system maintains strict relational integrity across 16 core database entities:

Table Name	Primary Keys & Foreign Keys	Key Attributes & Purpose
users	user_id (PK)	name, email (UK), password_hash, phone, department, hostel, verification_level, trust_score
categories	category_id (PK)	category_name, icon_name, description (13 UMaT equipment/hostel categories)
listings	listing_id (PK) owner_id, category_id (FK)	title, listing_type (Hostel/Equipment), rental_rate_per_day, status (Available/Reserved/Rented/Maintenance), location
rental_requests	request_id (PK) listing_id, borrower_id (FK)	start_date, end_date, purpose, status (Pending/Approved/Rejected/Cancelled)
rental_transactions	transaction_id (PK) request_id (FK)	gross_amount, commission_amount (10%), lender_earnings, actual_return_date, status (Active/Returned/Overdue/Damaged)
maintenance	maintenance_id (PK) listing_id, reported_by (FK)	issue_description, cost, status (Reported/In Progress/Completed), repair dates
user_wallets	wallet_id (PK) user_id (FK UK)	available_balance, locked_escrow_balance, currency (GHS), updated_at
wallet_transactions	w_tx_id (PK) wallet_id (FK)	transaction_type, amount, fee, reference_type, status, idempotency_key
services	service_id (PK) provider_id (FK)	title, service_category, base_rate, delivery_time_days, status
reviews	review_id (PK) transaction_id (FK)	reviewer_id, reviewee_id, rating (1-5), comment, created_at

4. Key Business Logic & Financial Algorithms

A. Financial Double-Entry Wallet & Escrow Engine

All transactions are logged in a double-entry ledger. Upon rental request approval, the borrower's wallet balance is locked in escrow:

Gross Amount = Rental Rate per Day × Rental Days

Upon successful return, the escrow is unlocked and settled:

Platform Commission = Gross Amount × 10%

Lender Earnings = Gross Amount - Platform Commission

B. Equipment Damage & Maintenance Lifecycle

When an item is returned damaged, the transaction status updates to **Damaged**, the listing status updates to **Maintenance**, and a maintenance repair ticket is automatically created logging estimated repair costs.

C. Dynamic Student Trust Score Algorithm

Every user is assigned a dynamic Trust Score (0–100) calculated as:

Trust Score = min(100, 50 + (Avg Rating × 8) + (Completed Rentals × 2) - (Overdue Days × 5) - (Damage Incidents × 10))

5. Re-Architecting Strategy & Best Modern Tech Stack

To rebuild CampusLink from scratch into a scalable, high-throughput, enterprise campus platform, the following modern technology stack is recommended:

Architecture Tier	Recommended Tooling	Key Advantages & Capabilities
Backend Framework	Python FastAPI (or Node.js NestJS)	High performance async I/O, automatic OpenAPI Swagger docs, native Pydantic validation.
Database Engine	PostgreSQL + PostGIS	ACID financial ledgers; PostGIS enables geospatial queries (e.g., 'Find hostels within 500m of UMaT main gate').
ORM & Migrations	SQLAlchemy v2 + Alembic (or Prisma)	Type-safe async queries, structured schema migrations, zero SQL injection risk.
Frontend Framework	Next.js 14+ (React 18 + TS)	Server-side rendering (SSR), SEO for hostel listings, instant client-side route transitions.
UI Design & Components	Tailwind CSS + Shadcn UI	Ultra-clean glassmorphic UI, responsive layouts, native dark/light theme switching.
Mobile & Desktop App	Flutter (or React Native)	Single cross-platform codebase compiling natively to Android, iOS, Windows, and macOS.
Payments Gateway	Hubtel API / Paystack Ghana	Native Mobile Money integration for MTN MoMo, Telecel Cash, and bank cards in Ghana.
Background Workers	Celery / Taskiq + Redis	Asynchronous payment webhooks, daily overdue rental sweepers, email/SMS alerts.

DevOps & Hosting	Docker + Nginx + Render/Vercel	Containerized microservices, SSL termination, multi-stage builds.
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6. Project Conclusion & Next Steps

CampusLink / HostelHub represents a fully realized, multi-interface campus ecosystem tailored to UMaT Tarkwa. The active system is verified 100% operational with 127 automated tests passing. Rebuilding the platform using **FastAPI**, **PostgreSQL/PostGIS**, **Next.js 14**, and **Flutter** will provide an production-ready foundation capable of scaling across tertiary institutions in Ghana.